

Ministry of Water, Land and Resource Stewardship

High Streamflow Advisory – North Coast, Central Coast

Issued: 11:00 AM September 25, 2025

The River Forecast Centre is issuing a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- North Coast including tributaries and smaller streams around Stewart, Gitlaxt'aamiks (New Aiyansh), Terrace, Prince Rupert, Kitimat, and other coastal communities
- Central Coast including tributaries and smaller streams around Bella Coola, Rivers Inlet, and other coastal communities

*****NOTE: The ongoing job action by the B.C. General Employees' Union (BCGEU) and the Professional Employees Association (PEA) has affected River Forecast Centre (RFC) data systems and work processes. Due to these impacts, RFC staff are unable to access the full range of information that is typically used to generate forecasts and advisories. As a result, current forecasts have a higher degree of uncertainty and should be interpreted with caution.*****

Weather Synopsis:

After two significant storm systems impacted the North and Central coasts last weekend, another storm is expected to arrive late Thursday bringing moderate to heavy rainfall totals on Friday and into Saturday. Combined rainfall amounts for Friday-Saturday could reach 50-100 mm total for the event in some areas. Currently, weather models predict the storm to move southwards towards Vancouver Island and the South Coast through the weekend.

River Conditions:

Rivers are flowing at normal to above normal levels in the North and Central coasts due to recent storm events, with several rivers reaching above 2-year and 5-year return period flows on Monday. Due to persistent rainfall events over the past few weeks, the soil moisture for the North and Central coasts is saturated. The combination of relatively high river levels and saturated soils means rivers are more susceptible to rapid rises even with moderate precipitation totals.

It is also important to note that streamflow impacts may be especially severe in smaller streams, many of which are not gauged. Smaller streams may respond to rainfall much more rapidly and dramatically than larger rivers, with higher flows relative to their channel size.

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Streamflows are expected to begin rising rapidly with the arrival of the heaviest rainfall by Friday evening, and flows may continue rising for several days. Peak flows in most systems are anticipated to occur Saturday to Sunday based on watershed size.

Fast-flowing rivers pose increased risk to life safety. The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

For information on how to prepare for flood hazards, visit [PreparedBC](#).

BC River Forecast Centre

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A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Fast-flowing bodies of water increase risk to life safety. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.